

Wael Shahadeh

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EDUCATION

Marist University, Poughkeepsie, NY

Bachelor of Science in Cybersecurity

Expected May 2027

Minors: Computer Science, Information Systems, Information Technology, Criminal Justice

PROJECTS & COMPETITIONS

Security Homelab & Self-Hosted Platform | wael.sh

2025 - Present

Proxmox · AdGuard Home · Tailscale · Cloudflare · Rust

- Built an environment on Proxmox, separating a Tailscale-only management plane from Cloudflare-fronted public services.
- Deployed AdGuard Home for network-wide DNS filtering across 4 devices, blocking ads, trackers, and known-malicious domains.
- Built a Rust backend serving a publicly readable signed feed. The signing key is isolated in a dedicated container so that no public read path can reach it.
- Investigated anomalous inbound traffic to a public API endpoint, and classified it as untargeted internet background scanning instead of a targeted attack.

GDDC Blue Team Defense Competition

April 2026

- Received team MVP award; placed 5th of 11 teams defending a simulated compromised corporate network across service uptime, business injects, CTF challenges, and executive interviews.
- Built a 7-VM VirtualBox practice environment from scratch for preparation, resolving routing conflicts, credential and GRUB recovery, and dependency issues.

EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, OpenHub Project

June 2026 - Present

- Developed Security+ and CySA+ curriculum for adult career-changers entering cybersecurity, covering security operations.
- Designed and led hands-on projects, from initial scoping through completion, for 15 learners transitioning into tech roles, including diagnosing and repairing home devices.
- Taught cybersecurity fundamentals and practical AI tooling such as Gemini and Claude for phishing detection to learners with non-technical backgrounds.

Undergraduate Researcher, Malware Detection, Marist University

October 2025 - Present

- Develop ML behavioral detection models for multiple macOS malware families, including adware and stealers, using Endpoint Security Framework telemetry.
- Execute live samples in an isolated lab (macOS endpoints, Ubiquiti Dream Machine Pro, Faronics Deep Freeze) for safe detonation and repeatable data collection.
- Collect and analyze eslogger telemetry with SpriteTree to identify behavioral indicators of malicious activity.
- Contribute to automation tooling for malware log analysis

Intern, Marist University, PC Repair

October 2025 - Present

- Diagnose and refurbish 5 donated PCs daily, installing OSES and troubleshooting hardware issues.
- Collaborate with other interns to optimize imaging workflows and device repair processes.
- Maintain detailed diagnostic documentation and system performance logs.

Resident Assistant, Marist University

August 2024 - Present

- Serve as a first point of contact for 50+ residents at Marist University, fostering a safe and inclusive community. Responsible for 270+ residents on a rotating shift basis.
- Plan and facilitate monthly educational and social programs promoting student well-being and academic success.
- Conduct Health & Safety inspections, wellness checks, and incident documentation in collaboration with Residence Life.

LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

Cybersecurity Club (External Outreach Board Member), Marist University

January 2026 - Present

- Coordinate conferences between the Cybersecurity Club and outside organizations, directly managing 20+ members.
- Conduct outreach to Fortune 100 businesses and facilities to showcase cybersecurity work in a practical setting.